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www.linkedin.com/in/peter-prokunin-17111822 (LinkedIn)
peterpro.github.io/ (Portfolio)

Top Skills

KYC Verification

Node.js

Anti-Money Laundering

Languages

Spanish (Elementary)

English (Full Professional)

Russian (Native or Bilingual)

Publications

Interview in alumni magazine.

Peter Prokunin

Independent backend architect / CTO | peterpro.github.io
Barcelona, Catalonia, Spain

Summary

Independent contractor specializing in backend and platform engineering, with strong experience in PHP (Symfony), Node.js (NestJS), system architecture, and technical leadership. Focused on building scalable, maintainable systems and establishing engineering practices that support long-term product growth.

Takes a pragmatic approach to AI, integrating AI capabilities where they provide measurable business value and building AI-enabling infrastructure for production workflows. Experienced across AWS, Google Cloud, and bare-metal environments, selecting infrastructure based on technical and business constraints.

Proven track record delivering high-load systems and leading distributed teams across fintech, regtech, and e-commerce domains, including neo-banking and multi-integration platform projects.

Experience

NDA

Principal Developer

April 2024 - Present (2 years 6 months)

United Kingdom

Principal Developer in NDA FinTech / RegTech platform focused on complex ownership structures, compliance workflows and financial infrastructure.

Worked on architecture and development of a platform supporting corporate onboarding, beneficial ownership analysis and regulated financial operations involving trusts, guardians, corporate entities and multi-level ownership chains.

Key responsibilities and achievements:

- Designed and developed core backend services for KYB/KYC, AML and payments processing workflows

- Worked on modeling and traversal of complex ownership and relationship structures using a custom graph-based engine
- Built and maintained public-facing APIs in NestJS layered above internal private APIs and core services implemented in Go
- Participated in architecture decisions around entity resolution, risk evaluation, onboarding orchestration and compliance automation
- Implemented scalable asynchronous workflows and event-driven communication between services
- Contributed to auditability, traceability and regulatory reporting capabilities required in regulated environments
- Participated in technical leadership, architecture reviews and engineering standards definition across backend teams

Freelance

Independent Contractor

September 2019 - Present (7 years 1 month)

As an Independent Contractor, I design and deliver backend and platform solutions aligned with specific business and product requirements. My background includes PHP (Symfony) and Node.js (NestJS) development, system architecture, and technical project leadership. I focus on building maintainable, scalable systems and establishing engineering processes that support long-term product evolution.

I have experience leading distributed teams, coordinating development in high-load environments, and working directly with stakeholders to translate business constraints into technical implementations. I have delivered projects across multiple domains while working in remote and cross-functional setups. I work confidently across AWS and Google Cloud environments, as well as bare-metal and self-hosted infrastructure when required by cost, compliance, or performance constraints.

Among delivered projects:

- neo-banking startup (B2B)
- e-gifting service with multiple integrations
- other fin-tech, reg-tech and e-commerce projects

Key Skills:

- Business requirements analysis
- System and architecture design

- PHP / Node.js backend development
- Technical project leadership
- Team setup and mentoring
- Highload / distributed / cloud systems
- AI-enabling
- Stakeholder communication

Silverbird

Development Team Leader

July 2021 - February 2024 (2 years 8 months)

United Kingdom

In the Silverbird I led the “payment provider connections factory” - a dedicated engineering stream responsible for scalable integration and maintenance of banking, PSP and payment infrastructure connectors.

Key responsibilities and achievements:

- Led a cross-functional backend engineering team delivering integrations with payment providers, core banking banks and external financial services
- Designed and evolved a modular integration architecture for PSP connectors, onboarding flows, KYC/eIDV providers and transaction processing
- Built standardized connector framework reducing time-to-market for new providers and improving maintainability
- Coordinated delivery across product, compliance and operations teams in highly regulated fintech environment
- Implemented resilient asynchronous workflows using event-driven architecture and message brokers
- Improved observability, failure recovery and reconciliation processes for payment flows
- Participated in architecture decisions around PCI DSS, auditability, idempotency and transactional consistency
- Mentored engineers, conducted technical planning, code reviews and incident management
- Worked with high-load B2B banking APIs, payment routing and partner integrations
- Contributed to scaling engineering processes, delivery predictability and technical standards across integration teams

TSUM Moscow

PHP Team Leader

June 2018 - December 2020 (2 years 7 months)

Moscow, Moscow City, Russia

I led a team working on a complex marketing platform that processed and managed millions of event records.

Responsibilities:

- Managed a PHP development team and project backlog
- Facilitated communication with clients and other development teams
- Coordinated development and release processes
- Worked closely with the DevOps team

Key project:

Developed a system for efficient marketing campaign management based on large-scale event data.

JivoChat

PHP Team Lead

June 2017 - July 2018 (1 year 2 months)

Moscow, Russian Federation

- team management (hiring / management / coaching)
- acted as lead developer
- system architecture

Badoo

Senior PHP Developer

January 2016 - June 2017 (1 year 6 months)

- introduced internal tests statistic system
- participated as sole developer in special project (Chappy)

Digital Society Laboratory

CTO

November 2014 - December 2015 (1 year 2 months)

Moscow, Russian Federation

- team management (10+) / hiring
- system architecture
- product description
- project management

Mail.Ru

CTO in Torg.mail.ru

May 2013 - August 2014 (1 year 4 months)

Mosocw

Responsibilities

- Managing personnel (dev / UI / QA): 17 people
- Managing infrastructure (> 40 dev/prod servers)
- Managing application architecture
- Strategic planning
- Quality control processes
- Project management

Achievements

- Implemented strategic planning for resources, projects, and needs
- Successfully delivered a large number of product and R&D projects
- Achieved uptime > 99.99%
- Established QA processes from scratch
- Formed effective working teams
- Developed a workflow from requirement intake to post-release acceptance
- Eliminated SPOF / ensured full operational capability when one out of three data centers goes down

Enter LLC

1 year 4 months

Project Manager

March 2012 - April 2013 (1 year 2 months)

Acting as Project/Product Manager.

- tracking & managing resources / deadlines / requirements
- building project environment
- communicating with internal customers and development team
- supporting customers
- maintaining documentation

Lead Developer

January 2012 - October 2012 (10 months)

Team management.

Release engineering.

Wikimart

2 years 1 month

Development Team Leader

August 2010 - December 2011 (1 year 5 months)

Software architecture development.

Team management.

Developer

December 2009 - December 2011 (2 years 1 month)

Fashiontime.ru

Developer

February 2009 - May 2009 (4 months)

Education

Higher School of Economics

MSc, Business Informatics · (2008 - 2010)

Higher School of Economics

Bachelor, Business Informatics · (2004 - 2008)